PacketCheck

Free to print and copy

Let a stranger into your computer? What to do in the first hour.

These calls are convincing, and they happen to careful people. Do these steps in order. You do not need to buy anything.

1 Disconnect from the internet.

Turn off Wi-Fi or unplug the cable. Leave it off until you have finished these steps.

2 Call your bank.

Use the number on the back of your card, not one the caller gave you. Tell them what happened and ask them to watch for transfers. Do the same if you paid with gift cards or a money transfer app.

3 Change your passwords from another device.

Use your phone or a trusted computer. Start with your email, then banking, then anything that shares a password. Turn on two-step sign-in.

4 Remove the remote-control app.

Windows: Settings → Apps. Mac: Applications folder. Look for AnyDesk, TeamViewer, ScreenConnect, UltraViewer, RustDesk, LogMeIn or Supremo, and uninstall anything you did not choose yourself.

5 Check what was left behind.

Remote-control apps leave services and startup items after you delete them. Look for new user accounts too. Or run the free PacketCheck scan, which checks all of this in about 30 seconds.

6 Run a full antivirus scan.

Windows Security → Virus & threat protection → Scan options → Microsoft Defender Offline scan.

7 Report it.

US: reportfraud.ftc.gov and ic3.gov. UK: actionfraud.police.uk. Reporting helps stop the same callers.

Free check: packetcheck.net. It reads, changes nothing and uploads nothing.
Nobody from PacketCheck will ever call you or ask to connect to your computer.

packetcheck.net